



Greenland (the largest island in the world) belongs to **Denmark**, for example, and the small islands of St. Pierre and Miquelon, near the east coast of Canada, belong to **France**. Several of the the Caribbean islands (such as

Martinique and Guadeloupe) also belong to France, while others are territories of the **Netherlands** (like Aruba), the **United Kingdom** (Cayman Islands), or the **United States** (Virgin Islands).

Statistics



LANGUAGES

French features prominently because it is spoken widely in the Caribbean, as well as being one of Canada's two official languages.

English	236 million
Spanish	160 million
Indigenous langs	81.3 million
French	14.5 million



RELIGIONS

Because of the high incidence of immigration in this region, virtually every world religion is practiced here somewhere.

Roman Catholic	156 million
Protestant	104 million
Jewish	6.2 million
Muslim	5.5 million



URBAN POPULATION

In each case, the figures given include suburbs as well as inner city areas, which contain considerably fewer people.

New York City	21 million
Mexico City	21 million
Los Angeles	16 million
Chicago	9 million



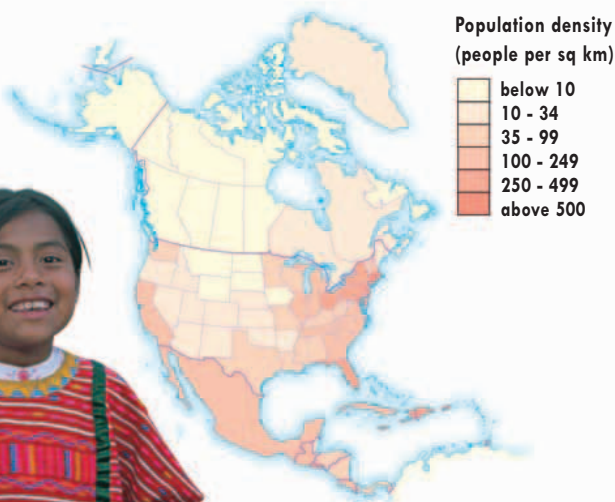
POPULATION BY COUNTRY

Despite having the biggest land mass in the region (and the second biggest in the world), Canada has just 32 million people.

US	280.5 million
Mexico	103.4 million
Canada	32 million
Guatemala	13.3 million

POPULATION

The island of Barbados, which is only 166 sq miles (430 sq km) in size, has the region's highest population density—1,658 people per sq mile (640 people per sq km).



NORTH & CENTRAL AMERICA FACTS

PLACES

Number of countries23 (plus dependencies)
 Highest pointMt. McKinley (Denali), Alaska, US,
 20,321 ft (6,194 m)
 Lowest pointBadwater, Death Valley, California, US,
 282 ft (-86 m)
 Biggest countryCanada, 3,560,216 sq m (9,220,970 sq km)
 Smallest countryGrenada, 131 sq m (340 sq km)

PEOPLE

Total population490 million
 Proportion living in urban areas72%

LITERACY RATE

90% of the population

HEALTH

People per doctor719
 Proportion with access to clean water93%